

Derbyshire Shared Care Pathology Guidelines

Malarial Parasite Screens

A purple top (EDTA) sample is required for Malarial Parasite screening.

- Initial screening is by an immunochromatographic antigen-detection rapid detection test (RDT)
- Confirmation of the initial result is performed by review of thick and thin blood films
- See page 2 for the malarial parasite screening pathway

Negative Results

- Absence of malarial parasites is always confirmed by microscopy. However, a negative Rapid Diagnostic Test and no malarial parasites seen by microscopy DOES NOT exclude a diagnosis of malaria. A repeat Malarial Parasite test should be urgently requested if clinically indicated.
- Please note that Plasmodium knowlesi is known to have a rapid replication rate (within 24 hours) resulting in high levels of parasitaemia and if untreated can be potentially fatal. P. knowlesi has currently been reported from Thailand, Myanmar, the Malaysian peninsular, Borneo, the Philippines and Singapore. Therefore, if the patient has a negative malarial parasite result but has a strong clinical indication of malaria then repeat a Malarial Parasite test should be requested urgently within 24 hours.

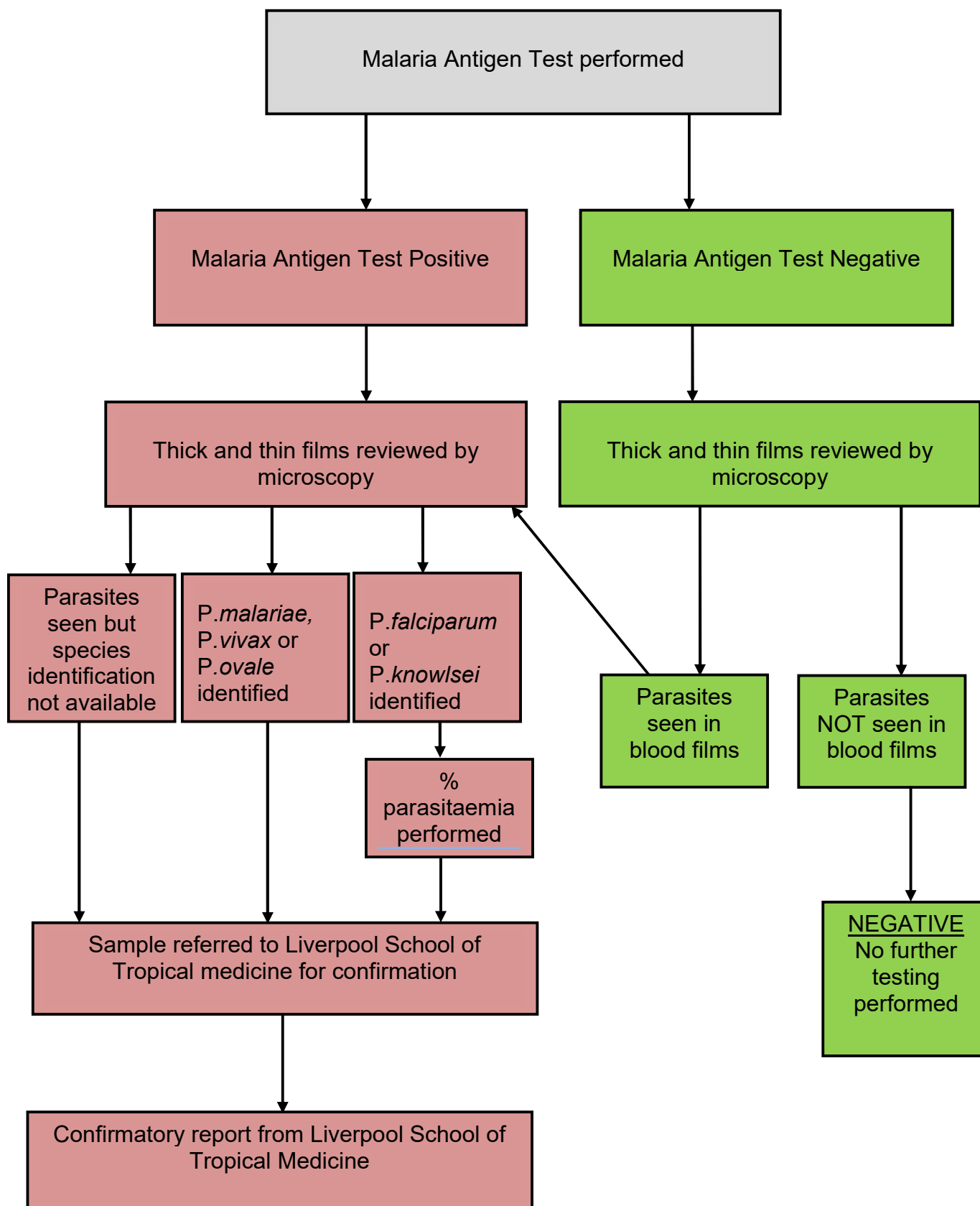
Positive Results

- Presence of malarial parasites is confirmed by microscopy
- All positive samples are then referred to Liverpool School of Tropical Medicine for confirmation

Clinical advice

- For clinical advice on treatment of parasitic diseases please contact one of the consultant physicians at Liverpool School of Tropical Medicine via the on call mobile telephone 07909 910899. This telephone is in operation Monday to Friday 9am to 5pm. Out of hours this number will transfer to Infectious diseases unit at the Royal Liverpool University Hospital.
- If any issues occur regarding transfer of call out of hours please telephone the RLUH switchboard and ask for Infectious diseases 0151 7062000.

Malarial Parasite Screening Pathway



Contacts

Urgent queries:

RDH Consultant Haematologist
CRH Consultant Haematologist

Via RDH switchboard
Via Consultant Connect or on-call Consultant through
CRH switchboard
Via QHB Switchboard

QHB Consultant haematologist

Non urgent queries:

RDH Consultant Haematologist
CRH Consultant Haematologist
QHB Consultant Haematologist

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Approval	Date	Name(s)	Designation
Primary Care	27/01/2026	Dr P Blackwell	GP
Laboratory (Derbyshire Pathology)	17/12/2025	Mrs L Morris	Technical Specialist Manager Haematology and Anticoagulation
	26/01/2026	Ms V G Ford	Senior Biomedical Scientist, Specialist Haematology
	06/02/2026	Ms S Knowles	Consultant Clinical Scientist